

Kirill Kazakov

DevOps / Platform Engineering Lead

Co-author of "Kubernetes Cookbook" · CKA · AWS SAA · GCP Professional Cloud Architect · OSS maintainer · 500+ engineers mentored

Remote (UTC+3) · Open to relocation (worldwide)

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Summary

Platform/DevOps leader with 9+ years in Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform, and CI/CD - combining hands-on platform delivery with team leadership. As part-time CTO of a DeFi startup, built the engineering team and shipped a platform to 350,000+ users (1.2B+ transactions); at GlobalDots drove platform adoption across 6 enterprise clients; as Lead DevOps at Simplinic introduced IaC self-service and trained dev/QA teams. Instructor for 500+ engineers (OTUS), co-author of "Kubernetes Cookbook". Strong in platform strategy, developer experience, FinOps, and building engineering practices from scratch.

Key achievements:

- Built engineering team and practices from day one (hiring, code review, CI/CD, observability); shipped DeFi platform to 350k+ users, 60k MAU (Aura X Capital)
 - Drove self-service platform adoption for 100+ microservices - reusable CI/CD, Argo family GitOps core (Justt via GlobalDots)
 - Delivered company-wide Terraform registry and IaC training; dev/QA teams consume infrastructure independently (Simplinic)
 - Mentored 500+ engineers as Kubernetes/DevOps instructor (OTUS, 2021-2025); 30+ publications, 100k+ reads
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Technical Skills

Category	Skills
Leadership & Practices	Team build-out, hiring & technical interviews, mentoring (500+ engineers), IaC training, engineering culture (code review, post-mortems), FinOps & budget ownership
Kubernetes & Platform	Kubernetes, EKS, GKE, Helm, Karpenter, KEDA, ArgoCD, Argo Events, Argo Workflows, Gateway API
Cloud (AWS)	AWS - SoW assessment, MORA, MODA; architecture design & migration design for clients; broad service portfolio (EKS, ECR, event-driven, multi-client production)
Cloud (other)	GCP; Cloudflare (DNS, Workers, Pages, Zero Trust, IaC)
IaC & GitOps	Terraform, Terragrunt, GitOps, FluxCD

Category	Skills
CI/CD	GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab CI - reusable pipelines, service catalog integration
Reliability (SRE)	SLO/SLI design, incident response, post-mortems, 4 Golden Signals, zero-downtime rollouts (PDB)
Observability	Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, OpenTelemetry, Datadog
Security	RBAC, OAuth, Network Policies, Zero Trust, CIS Benchmark
Languages & Tools	Python (automation, scripts), Bash, Docker, Linux, Git

Professional Experience

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - part-time

Aura X Capital | Jul 2024 - present (*parallel to GlobalDots through Feb 2026*)

DeFi vault platform on TON (EVM in progress), 350,000+ users. Key cases:

- **Engineering team build-out** - Recruited and onboarded developers; established code review, CI/CD, and observability practices from day one; team shipped platform to 350k+ users and 60k MAU
- **Technology strategy** - Architecture and tech direction for algorithmic DeFi platform (RAUM Launchdrop, Omni DEX, Dynamic LP on TON); infrastructure for 1.2B+ user/on-chain transactions; budget and cost ownership
- **Greenfield AWS infrastructure** - EKS, Terraform, FluxCD/GitOps from scratch; Grafana (GitHub SSO), Prometheus, Loki; reusable GitHub Actions CI/CD for ~20 services
- **Custom CDN** - Designed and deployed cdnn.cloud to bypass regional blockages; integrated with main platform

Senior DevOps Engineer (DevOps as a Service)

GlobalDots | Apr 2022 - Feb 2026

Platform and infra delivery for 6 enterprise clients (FinTech, AI Security, Public sector).

- **Platform adoption & knowledge sharing** - Drove best-practice adoption across client teams; authored [GlobalDots ArgoCD troubleshooting eBook](#) (10k+ reach); reduced issue volume from development teams
- **Self-service CI/CD platform** - Built reusable GitHub Actions workflows and bash libraries for Justt (100+ microservices); standardized delivery across repos, reduced onboarding time for new services
- **Argo family integration** - Adopted ArgoCD (GitOps), Argo Events, Argo Workflows as unified platform for 100+ microservices at Justt; eliminated config drift, enabled self-service deployment
- **AWS assessment & migration design (official AWS Partner)** - Owned projects from business case to delivery: SoW-based assessments, AWS Well-Architected reviews, MORA/MODA-driven analysis; migrations qualified for AWS partner funding

- **Node warm-up for EKS** - Pod startup from 3h->seconds for 1000+ pods with 3GB images (Justt); [published solution](#) featured in Learn Kubernetes Weekly #116
- **KEDA + Karpenter FinOps** - KEDA autoscaling on message queue metrics (infra costs -5%); Karpenter bin packing and spot/on-demand mix (Justt; enterprise AI Security client)
- **Zero Trust IaC** - Cloudflare setup, IaC + CI/CD for zero-trust architecture, sub-organizational access separation for a public-sector government client

Clients: Justt (FinTech); other client names not disclosed per agreement - Crypto/gaming, AI Security, API Security, Public sector

Lead DevOps Engineer

Simplinic GmbH (IoT healthcare) | Aug 2019 - 2022

IoT platform for hospitals (10k+ assets, 15 hospitals). Key cases:

- **IaC training for dev/QA** - Delivered sessions (presentation, Q&A, live support) to full dev and QA team; reduced "black box" infra requests, improved collaboration
- **Terraform self-service** - Built custom Terraform modules for multi-env deployment; implemented company-wide Terraform registry (S3 + gzip modules, semantic versioning); modules reusable "like Helm charts"
- **4 Golden Signals observability** - Designed dashboards per environment in Grafana (Google SRE model); reduced time to find issues and analyze infrastructure
- **Cost optimization** - GCP preemptible nodes for dev/stage (costs -10%); PDB for zero-downtime rollouts

DevOps Engineer

LiveSystem (WebRTC streaming) | Apr 2017 - 2019

Sole DevOps in a one-pizza startup. CI/CD from scratch (Jenkins, TTM -90%); IaC (Ansible, provisioning 3 days->3 hours); monitoring (Zabbix, ELK). Support 20h/week->1h; DevOps estimates enabled multi-month roadmap planning (error margin <=30%).

Key Deliverables

- **Engineering org from scratch** - Team, practices, and platform for a 350k+ user DeFi product (Aura X Capital)
 - **Argo-based self-service platform** - ArgoCD + Argo Events + Argo Workflows as core platform for 100+ microservices; GitOps, event-driven pipelines (Justt)
 - **Reusable CI/CD framework** - GitHub Actions shared workflows + bash libs across 6+ client projects at GlobalDots; standardized delivery, reduced pipeline duplication
 - **Terraform registry & self-service IaC** - Company-wide registry with versioned modules; dev/QA teams trained to consume IaC independently (Simplinic)
 - **Gateway API Helm Charts** - Open-source K8s Gateway API charts on [Artifact Hub](#) (maintainer)
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Certifications

- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (2025, valid through 2027)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2022/2025, valid through 2028)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2021, CNCF/Linux Foundation)

- GitOps Fundamentals (2022, Codefresh)
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Education & Mentoring

- **OTUS** - Instructor (Kubernetes Platform + DevOps Practices), 2021-2025. 500+ students.
 - **SkillFactory** - DevOps Engineer Course author, 2021.
 - **Hackathon Judge:** Digital Breakthrough, IT INNOHACK, Globee Awards, MLH (12+ events).
 - **CI/CD workshops** - GitHub Actions workshops at AGORA HACK and IT_ONE DevOps Champion.
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Thought Leadership

- **[Kubernetes Cookbook](#)** (2024) - Co-authored 171pp, ISBN, Amazon; initiated the project and led a 3-person author team. Technical Reviewer - "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025).
 - **30+ publications** (100k+ total reads) - [K8s Scheduler internals](#) (Habr, 20k+), [K8s security & RBAC hardening](#) (DZone), DNS observability postmortem (HackerNoon), Production Readiness framework (adopted by VP Deutsche Bank).
 - **Conference speaker** - DevOps 2021 (Pulumi vs Terraform, ~400 attendees); OTUS CONF 2024 (Gateway API vs Ingress); FaangTalk podcasts (K8s, Chaos Engineering).
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Education

Saint Petersburg State University - Specialist Degree (5-year, equiv. MSc), Computer Software and Dataware, 2005-2010

Additional

- **Languages:** English (B2+, professional working proficiency), Russian (native)
- **Work setup:** Remote (UTC+3, overlap with EU hours); open to relocation worldwide (EU, Asia, US, and other regions)
- **Interests:** Platform strategy, developer experience, engineering culture, open source, technical writing, mentoring